Text 1

第 1 段

Hunting for a job late last year, lawyer Gant Redmon stumbled across CareerBuilder, a job database on the Internet. He searched it with no success but was attracted by the site's "personal search agent". It's an interactive feature that lets visitors key in job criteria such as location, title, and salary, then E-mails them when a matching position is posted in the database. Redmon chose the keywords legal, intellectual property and Washington, D.C. Three weeks later, he got his first notification of an opening. "I struck gold," says Redmon, who E-mailed his resume to the employer and won a position as in-house counsel for a company.

直译：去年年底找工作时，律师甘特·雷德蒙偶然发现了互联网招聘数据库 CareerBuilder。他在里面搜索没有成功，却被网站的“个人搜索代理”吸引了。这是一项互动功能，访问者可以输入地点、职位名称、薪水等求职条件；数据库中一旦发布符合条件的职位，系统就会给他们发送电子邮件。雷德蒙选择了“法律”“知识产权”和“华盛顿特区”等关键词。三周后，他收到了第一封职位空缺通知。他说：“我挖到金子了。”随后，他把简历用电子邮件发给雇主，获得了一家公司内部法律顾问的职位。

第 2 段

With thousands of career-related sites on the Internet, finding promising openings can be time-consuming and inefficient. Search agents reduce the need for repeated visits to the databases. But although a search agent worked for Redmon, career experts see drawbacks. Narrowing your criteria, for example, may work against you: "Every time you answer a question you eliminate a possibility," says one expert.

直译：互联网上有数千个职业相关网站，寻找有希望的职位可能既耗时又低效。搜索代理减少了反复访问数据库的需要。但是，虽然搜索代理对雷德蒙奏效了，职业专家仍看到了缺点。例如，缩小筛选条件可能反而对你不利。一位专家说：“每回答一个问题，你就排除了一种可能性。”

第 3 段

For any job search, you should start with a narrow concept—what you think you want to do—then broaden it. "None of these programs do that," says another expert. "There's no career counseling implicit in all of this." Instead, the best strategy is to use the agent as a kind of tip service to keep abreast of jobs in a particular database; when you get E-mail, consider it a reminder to check the database again. "I would not rely on agents for finding everything that is added to a database that might interest me," says the author of a job-searching guide.

直译：任何求职都应从一个较窄的想法 —— 你自认为想做什么 —— 开始，然后把它拓宽。另一位专家说：“这些程序没有一个会这样做。这一切里面并不包含职业咨询。”相反，最佳策略是把搜索代理当作一种线索提示服务，借此随时了解某个数据库中的职位；收到邮件时，就把它看成再次查看数据库的提醒。一位求职指南的作者说：“我不会依靠代理，指望它找出数据库新增的所有可能令我感兴趣的信息。”

第 4 段

Some sites design their agents to tempt job hunters to return. When CareerSite's agent sends out messages to those who have signed up for its service, for example, it includes only three potential jobs—those it considers the best matches. There may be more matches in the database; job hunters will have to visit the site again to find them—and they do. "On the day after we send our messages, we see a sharp increase in our traffic," says Seth Peets, vice president of marketing for CareerSite.

直译：一些网站在设计搜索代理时，就是为了吸引求职者再次访问。例如，CareerSite 的代理向注册用户发消息时，只列出三个潜在职位，即它认为最匹配的职位。数据库中可能还有更多匹配项，求职者必须再次访问网站才能找到，而他们确实会这样做。CareerSite 营销副总裁塞思·皮茨说："在我们发送消息的第二天，网站访问量会大幅增加。"

第 5 段

Even those who aren't hunting for jobs may find search agents worthwhile. Some use them to keep a close watch on the demand for their line of work or gather information on compensation to arm themselves when negotiating for a raise. Although happily employed, Redmon maintains his agent at CareerBuilder. "You always keep your eyes open," he says. Working with a personal search agent means having another set of eyes looking out for you.

直译：即使那些并不在找工作的人，也可能觉得搜索代理有用。有些人用它密切关注本行业的需求，或搜集薪酬信息，以便在商谈加薪时增强自己的筹码。雷德蒙虽然对现有工作很满意，却仍保留着 CareerBuilder 的代理。他说："你总得留心。"使用个人搜索代理，意味着又多了一双眼睛替你留意机会。

篇章简析

主旨：招聘搜索代理能提供便利与市场信息，但不能替代主动检索和职业判断。第 1 段成功案例不等于作者无保留推荐；第 2、3 段说明筛选会遗漏机会，第 4 段揭示网站吸引回访的动机。

Text 2

第 1 段

Over the past century, all kinds of unfairness and discrimination have been condemned or made illegal. But one insidious form continues to thrive: alphabetism. This, for those as yet unaware of such a disadvantage, refers to discrimination against those whose surnames begin with a letter in the lower half of the alphabet.

直译：过去一个世纪，各种不公平和歧视都遭到谴责或被宣布为非法。但一种隐蔽有害的形式仍然兴盛：字母顺序歧视。对那些还不知道这种不利处境的人来说，这指的是歧视那些姓氏首字母处于字母表后半部分的人。

第 2 段

It has long been known that a taxi firm called AAAA cars has a big advantage over Zodiac cars when customers thumb through their phone directories. Less well known is the advantage that Adam Abbott has in life over Zoe Zysman. English names are fairly evenly spread between the halves of the alphabet. Yet a suspiciously large number of top people have surnames beginning with letters between A and K.

直译：人们早就知道，当顾客翻阅电话簿时，一家叫 AAAA 的出租车公司，比叫 Zodiac 的公司有很大优势。较少为人所知的是，亚当 · 阿博特在生活中也比佐伊 · 齐斯曼有优势。英语姓名在字母表前后两半的分布相当均匀。然而，姓氏以 A 到 K 之间字母开头的上层人物，数量却多得令人怀疑。

第 3 段

Thus the American president and vice-president have surnames starting with B and C respectively; and 26 of George Bush's predecessors (including his father) had surnames in the first half of the alphabet against just 16 in the second half. Even more striking, six of the seven heads of government of the G7 rich countries are alphabetically advantaged (Berlusconi, Blair, Bush, Chirac, Chretien and Koizumi). The world's three top central bankers (Greenspan, Duisenberg and Hayami) are all close to the top of the alphabet, even if one of them really uses Japanese characters. As are the world's five richest men (Gates, Buffett, Allen, Ellison and Albrecht).

直译：例如，美国总统和副总统的姓氏分别以 B 和 C 开头；乔治 · 布什的前任中，有 26 位 —— 包括他的父亲 —— 的姓氏处于字母表前半部分，而处于后半部分的只有 16 位。更引人注目的是，七国集团富裕国家的七位政府首脑中，六位在字母排序上占优势：贝卢斯科尼、布莱尔、布什、希拉克、克雷蒂安和小泉。世界三位顶尖中央银行行长格林斯潘、杜伊森贝赫和速水，都接近字母表前端，尽管其中一位实际上使用日文汉字。世界五位最富有的人 —— 盖茨、巴菲特、艾伦、埃利森和阿尔布雷希特 —— 也是如此。

第 4 段

Can this merely be coincidence? One theory, dreamt up in all the spare time enjoyed by the alphabetically disadvantaged, is that the rot sets in early. At the start of the first year in infant school, teachers seat pupils alphabetically from the front, to make it easier to remember their names. So short-sighted Zysman junior gets stuck in the back row, and is rarely asked the improving questions posed by those insensitive teachers. At the time the alphabetically disadvantaged may think they have had a lucky escape. Yet the result may be worse qualifications, because they get less individual attention, as well as less confidence in speaking publicly.

直译：这仅仅是巧合吗？一种理论 —— 由那些按字母排序处于不利地位的人，利用他们享有的大量闲暇时间想出来 —— 认为，问题很早就开始了。幼儿学校第一学年开始时，老师为了更容易记住姓名，按字母顺序从前到后安排座位。于是，近视的小齐斯曼被困在后排，很少得到那些缺乏体谅的老师提出的、能促进进步的问题。当时，字母排序不利的学生或许觉得自己幸运地逃过了一劫。然而，结果可能是学业资历更差，因为他们受到的个别关注较少，在公众面前讲话的信心也较弱。

第 5 段

The humiliation continues. At university graduation ceremonies, the ABCs proudly get their awards first; by the time they reach the Zysmans most people are literally having a ZZZ. Shortlists for job interviews, election ballot papers, lists of conference speakers and attendees: all tend to be drawn up alphabetically, and their recipients lose interest as they plough through them.

直译：这种羞辱还在继续。大学毕业典礼上，姓氏以 A、B、C 开头的人自豪地最先领奖；等轮到齐斯曼们时，大多数人实际上已经在打瞌睡。求职面试的入围名单、选举选票、会议发言者和与会者名单，往往都按字母顺序编排，而接收名单的人在费力读下去时逐渐失去兴趣。

篇章简析

主旨：文章以幽默、讽刺笔调讨论字母排序可能带来的累积劣势。统计列举与一种理论并不足以证明因果，阅读时应区分观察、假设与调侃。第 3 段 As are ... 为倒装，意为“五位富翁也一样”；ZZZ 表示睡觉的声音。人物及职位按历史文章保留。

Text 3

第 1 段

When it comes to the slowing economy, Ellen Spero isn't biting her nails just yet. But the 47-year-old manicurist isn't cutting, filing or polishing as many nails as she'd like to, either. Most of her clients spend $12 to $50 weekly, but last month two longtime customers suddenly stopped showing up. Spero blames the softening economy. "I'm a good economic indicator," she says. "I provide a service that people can do without when they're concerned about saving some dollars." So Spero is downscaling, shopping at middle-brow Dillard's department store near her suburban Cleveland home, instead of Neiman Marcus. "I don't know if other clients are going to abandon me, too," she says.

直译：谈到经济放缓，埃伦·斯佩罗还没有紧张到咬指甲。但这位 47 岁的美甲师修剪、打磨和涂饰的指甲，也没有她希望的那么多。她的大多数顾客每周花 12 到 50 美元，但上个月，两名老顾客突然不再出现。斯佩罗把这归咎于经济走弱。她说："我是一个很好的经济指标。我提供的服务，是人们想节省几美元时可以不要的。"因此，斯佩罗正在降低消费档次：她不再去内曼·马库斯，而改去克利夫兰郊区家附近中档的迪拉德百货。她说："我不知道其他顾客是否也会抛弃我。"

第 2 段

Even before Alan Greenspan's admission that America's red-hot economy is cooling, lots of working folks had already seen signs of the slowdown themselves. From car dealerships to Gap outlets, sales have been lagging for months as shoppers temper their spending. For retailers, who last year took in 24 percent of their revenue between Thanksgiving and Christmas, the cautious approach is coming at a crucial time. Already, experts say, holiday sales are off 7 percent from last year's pace. But don't sound any alarms just yet. Consumers seem only mildly concerned, not panicked, and many say they remain optimistic about the economy's long-term prospects even as they do some modest belt-tightening.

直译：甚至在艾伦·格林斯潘承认美国过热经济正在降温之前，许多劳动者就已亲自看到了放缓迹象。从汽车经销店到 Gap 门店，随着购物者节制开支，销售已连续数月疲软。对零售商来说，消费者这种谨慎态度出现的时机十分关键；去年，他们全年收入的 24% 来自感恩节至圣诞节期间。专家说，节日销售的步伐已比去年慢 7%。但还不必急着拉响警报。消费者似乎只是略感担忧，并未惊慌；许多人说，即使他们适度节省开支，仍对经济的长期前景保持乐观。

第 3 段

Consumers say they're not in despair because, despite the dreadful headlines, their own fortunes still feel pretty good. Home prices are holding steady in most regions. In Manhattan, "there's a new gold rush happening in the $4 million to $10 million range, predominantly fed by Wall Street bonuses," says broker Barbara Corcoran. In San Francisco, prices are still rising even as frenzied overbidding quiets. "Instead of 20 to 30 offers, now maybe you only get two or three," says John Tealdi, a Bay Area real-estate broker. And most folks still feel pretty comfortable about their ability to find and keep a job.

直译：消费者说，他们并未绝望，因为尽管头条新闻骇人，他们自己的境况仍感觉相当不错。多数地区的房价保持稳定。房产经纪人芭芭拉·科科伦说，在曼哈顿，"400 万到 1000 万美元价位的住房市场正出现新的淘金热，主要由华尔街奖金推动"。在旧金山，即使疯狂竞价正在平息，价格仍在上涨。湾区房地产经纪人约翰·蒂尔迪说："以前有二三十份出价，现在可能只有两三份。"而且，大多数人仍然对自己找到并保住工作的能力相当放心。

第 4 段

Many folks see silver linings to this slowdown. Potential home buyers would cheer for lower interest rates. Employers wouldn't mind a little fewer bubbles in the job market. Many consumers seem to have been influenced by stock-market swings, which investors now view as a necessary ingredient to a sustained boom. Diners might see an upside, too. Getting a table at Manhattan's hot new Alain Ducasse restaurant used to be impossible. Not anymore. For that, Greenspan & Co. may still be worth toasting.

直译：许多人在这次放缓中看到了积极的一面。潜在购房者会为较低利率欢呼。雇主不会介意就业市场少一点泡沫。许多消费者似乎受到了股市起伏的影响；投资者现在把这种波动看作持续繁荣的一项必要成分。食客也可能看到好处。以前，想在曼哈顿新近大热的阿兰·杜卡斯餐厅订到位子是不可能的，现在不再如此了。单凭这一点，也许仍值得向格林斯潘及其同僚举杯。

篇章简析

主旨：经济虽在放缓，消费者仍相对乐观，并看到降温的一些好处。首段美甲师案例展现消费收缩；第 3 段收入资产与就业感受支撑信心；末段列举积极面。文章的谨慎乐观不同于否认放缓。

Text 4

第 1 段

Americans today don't place a very high value on intellect. Our heroes are athletes, entertainers, and entrepreneurs, not scholars. Even our schools are where we send our children to get a practical education not to pursue knowledge for the sake of knowledge. Symptoms of pervasive anti-intellectualism in our schools aren't difficult to find.

直译：如今，美国人并不十分重视理性思考。我们的英雄是运动员、演艺人员和企业家，而不是学者。甚至学校也是我们把孩子送去接受实用教育的地方，而不是为知识本身而追求知识的地方。在学校中寻找普遍存在的反智主义迹象，并不困难。

第 2 段

"Schools have always been in a society where practical is more important than intellectual," says education writer Diane Ravitch. "Schools could be a counterbalance." Ravitch's latest book, Left Back: A Century of Failed School Reforms, traces the roots of anti-intellectualism in our schools, concluding they are anything but a counterbalance to the American distaste for intellectual pursuits.

直译：教育作家黛安·拉维奇说："学校一直处在一个实用比思想更重要的社会里。学校本可以成为一种制衡力量。"拉维奇的新书《留级：一个世纪失败的学校改革》追溯了学校反智主义的根源，并得出结论：学校远未成为对美国社会厌恶思想追求这一倾向的制衡。

第 3 段

But they could and should be. Encouraging kids to reject the life of the mind leaves them vulnerable to exploitation and control. Without the ability to think critically, to defend their ideas and understand the ideas of others, they cannot fully participate in our democracy. Continuing along this path, says writer Earl Shorris, "We will become a second-rate country. We will have a less civil society."

直译：但学校能够、也应该成为这种力量。鼓励孩子拒绝精神生活，会使他们容易遭受利用和控制。如果没有批判性思考、捍卫自己观点、理解他人观点的能力，他们就无法充分参与我们的民主生活。作家厄尔·肖里斯说，继续沿着这条路走，"我们将成为一个二流国家，我们将拥有一个文明程度更低的社会"。

第 4 段

"Intellect is resented as a form of power or privilege," writes historian and professor Richard Hofstadter in Anti-intellectualism in American Life, a Pulitzer-Prize winning book on the roots of anti-intellectualism in US politics, religion, and education. From the beginning of our history, says Hofstadter, our democratic and populist urges have driven us to reject anything that smells of elitism. Practicality, common sense, and native intelligence have been considered more noble qualities than anything you could learn from a book.

直译：历史学家、教授理查德·霍夫施塔特在《美国生活中的反智主义》中写道："理性思考被当作一种权力或特权而遭人怨恨。"这本研究美国政治、宗教与教育中反智主义根源的书获得过普利策奖。霍夫施塔特说，从历史开端起，我们的民主与民粹冲动就促使我们拒绝任何带有精英主义气息的东西。实用性、常识和天生的聪明，一直被认为比从书本学到的任何东西都更高贵。

第 5 段

Ralph Waldo Emerson and other Transcendentalist philosophers thought schooling and rigorous book learning put unnatural restraints on children: "We are shut up in schools and college recitation rooms for 10 or 15 years and come out at last with a bellyful of words and do not know a thing." Mark Twain's Huckleberry Finn exemplified American anti-intellectualism. Its hero avoids being civilized—going to school and learning to read—so he can preserve his innate goodness.

直译：拉尔夫·沃尔多·爱默生和其他超验主义哲学家认为，学校教育和严格的书本学习对儿童施加了不自然的束缚："我们被关在学校和大学的背诵教室里十年或十五年，最后出来时满肚子词句，却什么也不懂。"马克·吐温的《哈克贝利·费恩历险记》体现了美国的反智主义。它的主人公为了保持天生的善良，逃避被文明化，也就是逃避上学和学习阅读。

第 6 段

Intellect, according to Hofstadter, is different from native intelligence, a quality we reluctantly admire. Intellect is the critical, creative, and contemplative side of the mind. Intelligence seeks to grasp, manipulate, re-order, and adjust, while intellect examines, ponders, wonders, theorizes, criticizes, and imagines.

直译：按照霍夫施塔特的说法，理性思考不同于天生的聪明；后者是一种我们勉强才愿意赞赏的品质。理性思考是心智中批判、创造和沉思的一面。聪明寻求理解、操控、重新安排和调整，而理性思考则审视、思索、疑问、建立理论、批评和想象。

第 7 段

School remains a place where intellect is mistrusted. Hofstadter says our country's educational system is in the grips of people who "joyfully and militantly proclaim their hostility to intellect and their eagerness to identify with children who show the least intellectual promise."

直译：学校仍然是一个不信任理性思考的地方。霍夫施塔特说，我国教育体系掌握在这样一些人手中：他们"欢欣而好斗地宣称自己敌视理性思考，并急切地认同那些最缺乏思想潜力的孩子"。

篇章简析

主旨：批评美国教育中的反智倾向，强调学校应培养批判与反思能力。关键是区分 intellect（反思、批判的心智能力）与 intelligence（天生聪明、解决实际问题的能力）。anything but 表"绝不是"；末段引文是霍夫施塔特的批评。

整理说明：依据所附年度试卷提取 Text 1–Text 4；每段英文后接中文直译。已修复明显断词、粘连、错字和标点损坏。文中数据、事件及观点均置于原文章的历史语境中理解。篇章简析为本次整理所加。